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Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT, VICE-PRESIDENT ATTEND OATH CEREMONY

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, attend the swearing-in ceremony of Sana Bint Mohammad Suhail, the newly-appointed Minister of Family, at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi yesterday.

UAE finalises deal to boost economic ties with Russia

Agreement also includes Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan and Kyrgyzstan

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The UAE has finalised an economic agreement with Russia, Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, collectively the Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU), to enhance non-oil trade by reducing tariffs and eliminating trade barriers. The Comprehensive Eco-

nomie Partnership Agreement aligns with the UAE's strategy to reduce reliance on oil revenues. In 2021, the UAE aimed to attract \$150 billion in foreign investment by strengthening its trade ties with emerging economies.

30% surge

In the first half of this year, bilateral non-oil trade between the UAE and the EAEU reached \$13.7 billion, marking a nearly 30 per cent increase from the previous year. Thani Bin Ahmed Al Zeyoudi, UAE's Minister of State for Foreign Trade, emphasised the EAEU's potential, noting its combined population of

200 million and GDP nearing \$5 trillion.

"The Economic Partnership Agreement with the UAE is a significant milestone, given the UAE's role as a global hub in the region," said Andrey Slepnev, member of the Eurasian Economic Commission Board.

This partnership is part of the UAE's broader strategy to access growing markets in the Middle East, Africa, Asia, and South America. The UAE's push into global trade deals led to record non-oil trade of Dh1.4 trillion (\$381.2 billion) in the first half of 2024, an 11 per cent increase from 2023.

SEE ALSO P6

Saudi Arabia ready for 'extraordinary' event

After Formula 1, Club World Cup, boxing and Ronaldo, kingdom lands 2034 World Cup

DUBAI
BY THOMAS WRAGG
Associate Editor

Formula 1, the Club World Cup, heavyweight boxing bouts and Cristiano Ronaldo have all found a home in Saudi Arabia in recent years, but the kingdom's ambition to become a global sporting capital reached new heights yesterday with the announcement that it will host the 2034 Fifa World Cup. Morocco, Spain and Portugal will jointly host the 2030 World Cup.

With an estimated 5 billion viewers tuning in to watch some portion of the last World Cup in Qatar, all eyes will once again turn to the Gulf for what

the Saudi Football Federation has promised to be an "extraordinary" tournament.

11 stadiums

As part of Saudi Vision 2030, spearheaded by Crown Prince Mohammad Bin Salman, the kingdom has committed to extensive infrastructure projects, including construction or renovation of 11 stadiums — three of which are already under way — and the addition of 185,000 new hotel rooms to accommodate the influx of visitors.

Although the official date for the tournament is yet to be confirmed, it is widely expected to take place in the winter. However, unlike Qatar's 2022 World Cup, which ran from November to December, Saudi Arabia's edition could see a shift in timing. There is speculation that the tournament may be held in January to avoid overlapping with Ramadan.

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'UAE does not dictate to others what to do'

GARGASH: NATION PRESENTS SUCCESSFUL REGIONAL MODEL WORTH EMULATING

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE refrains from dictating to other nations what to do, but offers a successful regional model to emulate, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the President, has said.

In a post shared on his X account, Dr Gargash said: "In a region often rife with conflicts, the UAE does not dictate to others what to do; instead, it presents a successful regional model worth to be emulated. With more than five decades of stability, justice and prosperity, the UAE has firmly established itself as a strong nation that stands tall and rises above any slogans or ideologies. Our achievements speak for themselves, and our message remains honest and clear."

Dr Gargash's remarks come three days after he commented on Syria's situation following the fall of Bashar Al Assad's regime. He noted: "Syria is still not out of the woods. If you look at the different dynamics, its territorial integrity remains fragmented."

Meanwhile, Qatar announced plans to reopen its embassy in Damascus soon. In a related

development, UN Secretary-General António Guterres reaffirmed the UN's commitment to a peaceful transfer of power in Syria, stating that the organisation is "totally committed to supporting a smooth transition of power."

Responding to international reactions, Syria's newly appointed Prime Minister, Mohammad Al Bashir, assured that the Islamist-led alliance would safeguard the rights of all religious groups and encouraged those who fled the war to return home. "Precisely because we are Islamic, we will guarantee the rights of all people and sects in Syria," Al Bashir said. In his interview with *Corriere della Sera*, Al Bashir said: "Mine is an appeal to all Syrians abroad: Syria is now a free country that has earned its pride and dignity. Come back."

SEE ALSO P10

Syria's newly appointed Prime Minister assured that the Islamist-led alliance would safeguard the rights of all religious groups and encouraged those who fled the war to return home.



SPORT

Guardiola:
I'm not going
to manage
another
team | P12

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